Social Media Platform Algorithm Blueprints

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Purpose: Algorithm-optimized strategies for each major platform to maximize organic reach and engagement

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Executive Summary

This document provides comprehensive blueprints for leveraging the algorithms of six major social media platforms. Each blueprint includes the core ranking factors, content optimization strategies, posting cadence, and tactical playbooks designed to work with (not against) each platform's algorithm.

These blueprints are designed for B2B and B2C outreach, brand building, and lead generation as part of the Project Genesis marketing infrastructure.

Platform 1: LinkedIn

Algorithm Overview

LinkedIn's algorithm is specifically designed to **prevent content from going viral** and instead prioritizes **relevant professional content** to users based on their interests, connections, and engagement history [1].

Core Principle: LinkedIn rewards expertise, knowledge sharing, and meaningful professional engagement over entertainment or viral content.

Ranking Factors (Priority Order)

Factor	Weight	Description
1. Content Quality	High	Original insights, industry expertise, actionable advice
2. First Hour Engagement	High	Comments and reactions in first 60 minutes ("Golden Hour")
3. Dwell Time	High	How long users spend reading your post
4. Network Relevance	Medium	Connection strength with viewers
5. Topic Authority	Medium	Consistent posting on specific niche topics
6. Comment Quality	Medium	Thoughtful comments from relevant professionals

Three-Step Algorithm Process

1. **Quality Filtering** - Posts immediately classified as spam, low quality, or high quality
2. **Engagement Testing** - Shown to small sample of audience; strong engagement = wider distribution
3. **Network & Relevance Ranking** - Prioritizes posts from people and topics you engage with most

Content Optimization Playbook

What Works:

- Original insights and industry analysis
- Personal stories with professional lessons
- Actionable advice and frameworks
- Carousel documents (high dwell time)
- Polls (high engagement)
- Text-only posts with clear structure

What Doesn't Work:

- Engagement bait ("Comment YES if you agree!")
- Excessive hashtags (limit to 3-5)
- Posting more than once per 12 hours
- Tagging unrelated people
- External links in post body (put in comments)

Posting Cadence

Frequency	Timing	Content Type
3-5x per week	Tuesday-Thursday, 8-10am	Thought leadership
1x per week	Any day	Carousel/Document
1x per week	Wednesday	Poll
Daily	Throughout day	Engage on others' posts

B2B Lead Generation Tactics

1. **Build Topic Authority** - Post consistently about one niche for 90 days
2. **Engage Before Posting** - Comment on 10-15 posts before publishing your own
3. **Use LinkedIn Articles** - For long-form content that stays discoverable
4. **Leverage Employee Advocacy** - Team members sharing company content
5. **DM Strategy** - Connect → Engage on their content → Personalized message

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Platform 2: X (Twitter)

Algorithm Overview

X's algorithm prioritizes **recency, engagement velocity, and relevance** to the user's interests. The "For You" feed uses machine learning to surface content from accounts you follow and accounts you might find interesting [2].

Core Principle: X rewards timely, engaging content that sparks conversation and gets rapid engagement.

Ranking Factors (Priority Order)

Factor	Weight	Description
1. Engagement Velocity	Very High	Likes, retweets, replies in first 30 minutes
2. Recency	High	Newer content prioritized
3. Media Attachments	High	Images, videos, polls boost visibility
4. Reply Depth	Medium	Threads with back-and-forth conversation
5. Account Authority	Medium	Follower count, verification, engagement history
6. Topic Relevance	Medium	Content matching user's interests

Content Optimization Playbook

What Works:

- Threads (multi-tweet stories) - 2-3x more engagement
- Images and videos - 150% more retweets
- Polls - High engagement, algorithm boost
- Quote tweets with commentary
- Timely takes on trending topics
- Controversial (but professional) opinions

What Doesn't Work:

- External links (suppress reach by 50%+)
- Hashtag overuse (1-2 max)
- Posting without engagement
- Automated/scheduled posts without engagement

Posting Cadence

Frequency	Timing	Content Type
3-5x per day	8am, 12pm, 5pm, 8pm	Short takes, commentary
2-3x per week	Any time	Threads (5-15 tweets)
1x per week	Peak hours	Poll
Continuous	Throughout day	Replies and quote tweets

Viral Content Formula

1. **Hook** - First line must stop the scroll (curiosity, controversy, value promise)
2. **Thread Structure** - Each tweet must stand alone but build narrative
3. **Call to Action** - End with engagement prompt (retweet, follow, reply)
4. **Self-Reply** - Reply to your own tweet with link (avoids algorithm penalty)

Platform 3: Instagram

Algorithm Overview

Instagram uses **multiple algorithms** - one for Feed, one for Stories, one for Reels, and one for Explore. Each has different ranking signals, but all prioritize **engagement, relevance, and relationship strength** [3].

Core Principle: Instagram rewards content that keeps users on the platform longer, with Reels currently receiving the highest algorithmic boost.

Ranking Factors by Format

Feed Algorithm:

Factor	Weight	Description
1. Relationship	Very High	How often you interact with this account
2. Interest	High	Predicted interest based on past behavior
3. Timeliness	Medium	Newer posts prioritized
4. Engagement	Medium	Likes, comments, saves, shares

Reels Algorithm:

Factor	Weight	Description
1. Watch Time	Very High	Percentage of video watched
2. Engagement	High	Saves and shares weighted highest
3. Audio Trending	Medium	Using trending sounds boosts reach
4. Completion Rate	Medium	Videos watched to end

Stories Algorithm:

Factor	Weight	Description
1. Relationship	Very High	Accounts you interact with most
2. Viewing History	High	Stories you consistently watch
3. Engagement	Medium	Replies, reactions, shares

Content Optimization Playbook

Reels (Highest Priority):

- 15-30 seconds optimal length
- Hook in first 1-3 seconds
- Use trending audio
- Text overlays for accessibility
- Post 4-7 Reels per week

Feed Posts:

- Carousel posts get 1.4x more reach than single images
- Detailed captions (150-300 words) boost engagement
- Post 3-5 feed posts per week

Stories:

- Post 5-10 Stories per day
- Use interactive stickers (polls, questions, quizzes)
- Behind-the-scenes content performs well

Engagement Hierarchy

Most Valuable to Least:

1. Saves (signals high value)
2. Shares (signals shareability)
3. Comments (signals conversation)
4. Likes (signals approval)

Posting Cadence

Format	Frequency	Best Times
Reels	4-7x per week	9am, 12pm, 7pm
Feed	3-5x per week	11am, 1pm, 7pm
Stories	5-10x per day	Throughout day
Lives	1-2x per week	Peak hours

Platform 4: TikTok

Algorithm Overview

TikTok's "For You Page" (FYP) algorithm is the most sophisticated content recommendation system, designed to surface content from **any creator** regardless of follower count. The algorithm prioritizes **watch time, engagement, and content relevance** [4].

Core Principle: TikTok rewards content that keeps users watching and engaging, giving every video a chance to go viral regardless of account size.

Ranking Factors (Priority Order)

Factor	Weight	Description
1. Watch Time	Very High	% of video watched, rewatches, loops
2. Engagement	High	Likes, comments, shares, saves
3. Video Completion	High	Videos watched to end
4. Content Relevance	Medium	Hashtags, sounds, captions matching interests
5. Account Activity	Medium	Posting consistency, engagement with others
6. Device/Account Settings	Low	Language, location, device type

Content Optimization Playbook

What Works:

- Hook in first 1-2 seconds (critical)
- 15-60 seconds optimal length
- Trending sounds and effects
- Text overlays
- Face-to-camera content
- Educational/value-driven content

- Pattern interrupts every 3-5 seconds

What Doesn't Work:

- Slow intros
- Watermarked content from other platforms
- Low-quality video/audio
- Overly promotional content
- Inconsistent posting

Video Structure Formula

1. **Hook (0-2 sec)** - Pattern interrupt, question, or bold statement
2. **Setup (2-5 sec)** - Context for what's coming
3. **Value (5-50 sec)** - Main content, tips, story
4. **Loop/CTA (last 2 sec)** - Encourage rewatch or action

Posting Cadence

Frequency	Timing	Content Type
1-3x per day	7am, 12pm, 7pm	Short-form content
Daily	Throughout day	Engage with comments
Weekly	Any time	Trend participation

Hashtag Strategy

- Use 3-5 hashtags per video
- Mix of: 1 broad (#business), 2 niche (#startuptips), 1-2 trending
- Avoid banned or overused hashtags

Platform 5: YouTube

Algorithm Overview

YouTube's algorithm optimizes for **watch time and session time** - how long users watch your videos and how long they stay on YouTube after watching. The algorithm surfaces content through Search, Suggested Videos, and Home Feed [5].

Core Principle: YouTube rewards content that keeps viewers watching longer and coming back to the platform.

Ranking Factors (Priority Order)

Factor	Weight	Description
1. Watch Time	Very High	Total minutes watched
2. Click-Through Rate (CTR)	Very High	% of impressions that result in clicks
3. Audience Retention	High	% of video watched on average
4. Engagement	High	Likes, comments, shares, subscribes
5. Session Time	Medium	How long viewers stay on YouTube after
6. Upload Frequency	Medium	Consistent posting schedule

Content Optimization Playbook

Thumbnail Optimization:

- High contrast colors
- Faces with emotion
- Text overlay (3-5 words max)
- Curiosity gap

Title Optimization:

- Front-load keywords
- Include numbers when possible

- Create curiosity without clickbait
- 60 characters or less

Video Structure:

- Hook in first 30 seconds
- Pattern interrupts every 2-3 minutes
- Clear value proposition
- End screen with next video

Content Types by Performance

Type	Watch Time	CTR	Best For
Tutorials	High	Medium	SEO, evergreen
Lists	Medium	High	Discoverability
Stories	High	Medium	Engagement
Shorts	Low	Very High	Subscriber growth

Posting Cadence

Format	Frequency	Best Times
Long-form	1-2x per week	Consistent day/time
Shorts	3-7x per week	Any time
Community Posts	2-3x per week	Any time

YouTube Shorts Strategy

- 15-60 seconds
- Vertical format (9:16)
- Hook in first 2 seconds
- Loop-friendly endings

- Cross-post from TikTok/Reels (remove watermarks)

Platform 6: Facebook

Algorithm Overview

Facebook's algorithm prioritizes **meaningful interactions** - content that sparks conversations between friends and family. Business content is deprioritized unless it generates genuine engagement [6].

Core Principle: Facebook rewards content that creates meaningful social interactions, especially in Groups and among close connections.

Ranking Factors (Priority Order)

Factor	Weight	Description
1. Meaningful Interactions	Very High	Comments, shares, reactions from close connections
2. Content Type	High	Video > Images > Links > Text
3. Recency	Medium	Newer content prioritized
4. Engagement Velocity	Medium	Early engagement signals quality
5. Page/Profile Authority	Medium	Engagement history, follower quality

Content Optimization Playbook

What Works:

- Native video (especially Live)
- Content that sparks discussion
- Facebook Groups (highest organic reach)
- Reels (currently boosted)
- User-generated content

- Behind-the-scenes content

What Doesn't Work:

- Engagement bait ("Like if you agree")
- External links (suppressed reach)
- Overly promotional content
- Posting without engagement strategy

Facebook Groups Strategy

Groups receive 5-10x more organic reach than Pages:

1. Create niche community around your topic
2. Post valuable content daily
3. Encourage member discussions
4. Use Units for structured content
5. Host regular Lives in the Group

Posting Cadence

Format	Frequency	Best Times
Page Posts	1-2x per day	1-4pm
Reels	3-5x per week	Any time
Stories	3-5x per day	Throughout day
Lives	1-2x per week	Peak hours
Group Posts	1-3x per day	Varies by group

Cross-Platform Strategy

Content Repurposing Matrix

Original Content	LinkedIn	X	Instagram	TikTok	YouTube	Facebook
Long-form article	Native post	Thread	Carousel	-	Video	Group post
Video (5-10 min)	Native	Clips	Reels	Clips	Full video	Native
Short video (60s)	Native	Native	Reels	Native	Shorts	Reels
Infographic	Document	Image	Carousel	-	Community	Image
Podcast episode	Clips	Clips	Audiogram	Clips	Full video	Clips

Platform Priority by Business Type

Business Type	Primary	Secondary	Tertiary
B2B Services	LinkedIn	YouTube	X
B2B SaaS	LinkedIn	X	YouTube
B2C Products	Instagram	TikTok	Facebook
Personal Brand	LinkedIn	X	YouTube
E-commerce	Instagram	TikTok	Facebook
Local Business	Facebook	Instagram	Google

Engagement Time Blocks

Dedicate 30-60 minutes daily to engagement across platforms:

Time	Activity
8-8:30am	LinkedIn engagement (comment on 10-15 posts)
12-12:30pm	X engagement (reply, quote tweet)
5-5:30pm	Instagram/TikTok engagement (comment, duet)
Evening	YouTube comments, Facebook Groups

Measurement Framework

Key Metrics by Platform

Platform	Primary Metric	Secondary Metrics
LinkedIn	Engagement Rate	Impressions, Profile Views, Connection Requests
X	Engagement Rate	Impressions, Profile Visits, Follower Growth
Instagram	Reach	Saves, Shares, Profile Visits, Follower Growth
TikTok	Views	Watch Time, Shares, Follower Growth
YouTube	Watch Time	CTR, Subscriber Growth, Audience Retention
Facebook	Reach	Engagement, Group Growth, Video Views

Weekly Review Checklist

- [ ] Review top-performing content across platforms
- [ ] Identify content themes that resonate
- [ ] Analyze posting times vs. engagement
- [ ] Track follower growth trends
- [ ] Review competitor content performance
- [ ] Plan next week's content calendar

Integration with Lightfield CRM

Lead Capture Workflow

1. **Social Engagement** → Identify engaged prospects
2. **Profile Research** → Gather context from social profiles
3. **Lightfield Entry** → Create contact with social context
4. **Outreach Sequence** → Personalized multi-channel approach
5. **Conversion Tracking** → Attribute leads to social source

Automation Opportunities

Trigger	Action	Platform
New follower (qualified)	Add to Lightfield	All
DM received	Create lead	LinkedIn, Instagram
Comment on post	Tag for follow-up	All
Content shared	Track influence	All

References

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Version History

Version	Date	Changes
1.0	Jan 15, 2026	Initial comprehensive blueprint

This document is part of the CEPHO Blueprint Library and should be reviewed quarterly as platform algorithms evolve.